

33 Making conversation

Short questions are a way of showing interest when you are talking with someone. Use them to keep the conversation going.

 **New language** Short questions

Aa Vocabulary Question words

 **New skill** Asking short questions

33.1 KEY LANGUAGE SHORT QUESTIONS

You already know the answers to short questions. Use them to invite the person speaking to say more.



I went to the movies last night.

Did you?

**Yes, I saw that new thriller.
It was really exciting.**

Was it?



For many verbs, use the auxiliary verb "do" to form the question.

With the verb "to be," invert the word order in the statement to make the short question.



33.2 FURTHER EXAMPLES SHORT QUESTIONS

I play golf every weekend at the club.

Do you?



He wasn't in the office this morning.

Wasn't he?



33.3 ANOTHER WAY TO SAY IT SHORT QUESTIONS

In US English, short questions are sometimes not inverted.

They didn't go to the theater last night.

They didn't?



There isn't any milk left in the fridge.

There isn't?

